Discounts & Promotions Policy

Owning area: Sales

Last reviewed: August 2026

Policy ID: SAL-POL-014

Effective date: 1 September 2026

Policy owner: Director of Commercial Operations

1. Purpose and Overview

This policy defines how IronStore plans, approves, launches, monitors, and closes discounts and promotional campaigns across its European e-commerce operations. It applies to customer-facing price reductions, voucher codes, bundles, free-gift offers, loyalty incentives, seasonal events, and marketplace promotions.

The policy is intended to support consistent commercial decisions while protecting margin, pricing accuracy, customer trust, and compliance with applicable European consumer and advertising requirements. No promotion may be published unless its commercial terms, funding source, customer eligibility, and end date are documented and approved.

2. Scope

This policy applies to:

- IronStore websites, mobile applications, email, push notifications, affiliates, and social channels.
- Promotions operated in EU and EEA markets, including EUR, GBP, SEK, DKK, PLN, and CZK price displays.
- Products sold directly by IronStore and approved marketplace listings.
- Supplier-funded, IronStore-funded, and jointly funded promotional activity.
- Public offers and restricted offers for loyalty members, employees, customer service recovery, or selected segments.

This policy does not replace:

- Country-specific legal review for price reduction announcements.
- The **Pricing and Markdown Standard (COM-STD-006)**.
- The **Customer Voucher Terms** published on each applicable storefront.
- Marketplace-specific promotional rules.

3. Policy Statement

IronStore promotions must be transparent, financially justified, technically controlled, and available on the terms communicated to customers. The advertised discount must be genuine, calculable, and supported by an approved reference price or promotional mechanism.

Promotions must not:

- Mislead customers about the size, duration, or availability of an offer.
- Be configured to apply to products, countries, channels, or customers outside the approved scope.
- Reduce the selling price below an approved minimum margin without written exception approval.
- Use a reference price that has not been validated under the applicable country rules.
- Be extended or relaunched solely to create artificial urgency.

The standard promotion record is the source of truth. It must be maintained in **PromoHub**, with links to the campaign brief, approval record, pricing validation, creative assets, and post-campaign results.

4. Promotion Planning and Approval

4.1 Campaign brief

The requesting team must create a PromoHub record at least:

- **10 business days** before launch for standard promotions.
- **15 business days** before launch for multi-country campaigns.
- **3 business days** before launch for an operational or customer-service recovery offer.

The brief must include:

- Campaign name, objective, owner, markets, channels, and customer segment.
- Start and end date, including time zone and any early-termination rule.
- SKU or category scope, stock assumptions, exclusions, and expected units.
- Discount type, funding split, expected revenue, gross margin, and budget.
- Customer-facing terms, voucher limits, and required legal wording.
- Tracking plan, reporting owner, and rollback procedure.

4.2 Approval thresholds

Approval is based on the greater of the planned promotional cost or expected margin impact:

- **Up to €10,000:** Category Manager and Commercial Finance Analyst.
- **€10,001–€50,000:** Head of Sales and Finance Business Partner.
- **€50,001–€150,000:** Commercial Director and Finance Director.
- **Above €150,000:** Chief Commercial Officer and CFO.
- **Any campaign below the approved minimum margin:** Commercial Director and Finance Director, regardless of value.

Non-standard terms require additional review:

- Legal review for price claims, “lowest price,” “last chance,” comparative advertising, or country-specific restrictions.
- Data Protection review where customer segmentation uses sensitive or restricted data.
- Marketplace Operations approval for third-party marketplace campaigns.
- Tax review where the offer changes VAT treatment, invoicing, or cross-border settlement.

Approvals must be recorded in PromoHub or the linked **ServiceNow** request. Email approval alone is not sufficient unless attached to the campaign record.

5. Discount and Promotion Rules

5.1 Percentage and fixed-price discounts

- The discount must be calculated from the approved base price in the **PriceGrid** system.
- The base price, promotional price, currency, and validity period must be consistent across the storefront and campaign creative.
- Rounding follows the local currency rules configured in PriceGrid.
- “Up to” claims must identify the applicable product range and must not imply that all products receive the maximum reduction.
- Product exclusions must be visible before checkout, not only in full terms.

For price-reduction communications, the responsible country team must validate the reference-price period required in that market. The validated reference price and evidence must be stored with the campaign record.

5.2 Voucher codes

Voucher codes must be generated and controlled in **VoucherAdmin**.

Required controls include:

- Unique code or approved reusable code with a defined audience.
- Start and expiry timestamp in Central European Time unless otherwise stated.
- Maximum redemptions, customer limit, and order limit.
- Eligible markets, channels, products, and minimum basket value.
- Treatment of delivery charges, gift cards, and already discounted products.
- Fraud controls, including code sharing and automated redemption monitoring.

Unless the campaign brief states otherwise, vouchers cannot be combined with another percentage discount, employee discount, or compensation credit. Customer service may issue a one-time recovery voucher up to **€25** without Sales approval, provided the reason is logged in **Zendesk**.

5.3 Bundles, multi-buy offers, and free gifts

Bundle pricing must show:

- The products included.
- The total price or saving.
- Any mandatory quantity or mix requirement.
- Whether substitutions are permitted.
- The availability condition for a free gift.

The free-gift SKU must be reserved in **StockPilot** before launch. If the gift becomes unavailable, the campaign must be paused or the approved substitute must be supplied. Checkout must not charge for a free gift unless the terms clearly explain a refundable deposit or similar mechanism.

Multi-buy discounts must be tested for partial quantities, returns, cancellations, and split shipments. The system must apply the discount consistently and show the allocation on the order confirmation.

5.4 Loyalty, employee, and targeted promotions

Targeted promotions must use approved audiences in **Customer360** and comply with applicable consent and opt-out settings.

- Loyalty offers must state membership eligibility and any points impact.
- Employee discounts may be used only by verified employees and approved household members.
- Employee discounts must not be combined with public promotions unless explicitly approved.
- Personalised offers must not use protected characteristics or restricted profiling attributes.
- Campaign files containing customer-level data must not be exported to unapproved tools.

6. Launch Controls and Monitoring

The Campaign Operations Specialist owns the pre-launch checklist. Testing must be completed in the relevant storefront, currency, device types, and payment flows.

At minimum, testing must verify:

- Correct product eligibility and exclusion logic.
- Correct displayed price, basket calculation, and tax treatment.
- Voucher acceptance, rejection, expiry, and redemption limits.
- Mobile and desktop creative, landing pages, and legal terms.
- Order confirmation, invoice, refund, and return calculations.
- Stock, delivery promise, and free-gift allocation.

A second person must complete the checklist for campaigns with an expected daily revenue above **€25,000**. Campaigns launch through **LaunchBoard** only after the status is set to “Approved for release.”

During the campaign, the owner reviews:

- Revenue, units, conversion, average order value, and gross margin.

- Voucher redemption and abnormal order patterns.
- Stock cover, cancellations, returns, and customer contacts.
- Paid-media spend and supplier funding accruals.

Monitoring is daily for major campaigns and at least every two business days for standard campaigns. The owner must pause a promotion and notify Commercial Operations if:

- The discount applies outside the approved scope.
- Margin is more than **3 percentage points** below forecast.
- A technical defect creates an unintended price.
- Fraud or automated code use exceeds the agreed threshold.
- Stock or fulfilment capacity cannot support the advertised offer.

Material customer-impacting errors must be escalated through the **Incident Management Standard (OPS-STD-009)**. Customer remediation is coordinated by Customer Experience and approved by Sales Operations.

7. Campaign Closure and Reporting

The campaign owner must close the promotion at the approved end time and confirm that cached pages, feeds, ads, and scheduled messages have been removed or updated. A campaign may be extended only through a recorded approval; the original end date must not be altered retrospectively.

Within **10 business days** of closure, the owner must complete the PromoHub review, including:

- Net sales, promotional cost, gross margin, and supplier contribution.
- Forecast versus actual performance.
- Redemption, cancellation, return, and fraud rates.
- Incremental sales assessment where data is available.
- Technical or customer issues and recommended corrective actions.

Finance records supplier-funded discounts and claims in **FinanceFlow**. Supporting evidence must be retained for **seven years**, or longer where a local statutory requirement applies.

8. Roles and Responsibilities

- **Commercial Director:** Owns policy exceptions and major campaign approval.
- **Sales / Category Manager:** Defines the offer, budget, product scope, and commercial objective.
- **Commercial Finance:** Validates margin, funding, forecast, and campaign results.
- **Legal and Compliance:** Reviews regulated claims, terms, and country-specific requirements.
- **Campaign Operations:** Configures, tests, launches, and closes promotions.
- **Pricing Team:** Maintains PriceGrid rules and validates reference prices.
- **Marketing:** Publishes approved creative and removes expired communications.

- **Customer Experience:** Handles customer remediation and records recovery vouchers.
- **Marketplace Operations:** Confirms marketplace configuration and partner compliance.
- **Data Protection Officer:** Advises on segmentation, consent, and customer data use.

9. Related Documents and References

- **COM-STD-006:** Pricing and Markdown Standard
- **SAL-GUI-003:** Campaign Brief and Approval Guide
- **SAL-WI-011:** PromoHub Launch Checklist
- **LEG-STD-004:** Consumer Pricing and Advertising Compliance Standard
- **OPS-STD-009:** Incident Management Standard
- **CX-PRO-008:** Customer Compensation and Recovery Procedure
- **FIN-PRO-012:** Supplier Funding and Promotional Accrual Procedure
- **Customer Voucher Terms:** Applicable storefront version
- PromoHub, PriceGrid, VoucherAdmin, Customer360, StockPilot, LaunchBoard, Zendesk, and FinanceFlow

10. Revision History

- **August 2026 – Version 4.0:** Added multi-country approval thresholds, reference-price evidence requirements, and campaign monitoring controls.
- **March 2025 – Version 3.2:** Introduced PromoHub as the mandatory campaign record and expanded voucher controls.
- **October 2023 – Version 3.0:** Consolidated country promotion guidance and added supplier-funded promotion procedures.